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Pad Sites on Walmart Properties

Where to Find Them, What's Available, What They Cost,
and Where the Traps Are

PREPARED FOR · Brady Smallwood — mception.ai consulting practice

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DEPTH · DEEP · 9 VERIFIED TRACKS + 3 GAP-FILL PASSES · 90 CITED SOURCES

Executive Summary

Walmart does lease pad sites on its own properties across the country — but the inventory is deliberately quiet. Walmart owns 3,728 of its 4,611 U.S. stores (80.9%) and typically the surrounding land [1], and its Bentonville real-estate arm, Walmart Realty, markets excess outlots, carve-outs, land tracts, and former stores nationwide through **walmartrealty.com** (the `realty.walmart.com` hostname is dead) [4][5] and two national broker channels: **CBRE's "Walmart Disposition Center"** (Midwest-led, three named brokers) [7] and **SRS Real Estate Partners' "Walmart U.S. Pad Site & Disposition Portfolio"** (national, sale and ground lease) [8]. Nearly everything is "contact broker for pricing" — there is no published rate card anywhere in the channel.

The verified floor of officially marketed Walmart pad/outlot inventory visible from search indexes is **30+ properties across 16+ states**, clustered in small and secondary Midwest/Plains markets (69% of indexed CBRE listings), typically 0.75–4 acres, offered flexibly "for sale or lease" [10]–[14][15]. The true portfolio is materially larger — the site itself showed **557 total listings of all types circa March 2023** [9] — but Walmart's portal and both broker portals are bot-blocked/JS-rendered, so a precise current census requires a 10-minute human browser session (the single highest-value follow-up from this research). Deal economics triangulate to roughly **\$27K–\$58K per acre per year** in ground rent depending entirely on the market (comps: Kapolei HI \$350K/yr on 0.74 ac; Charleston SC \$140K/yr on 1 ac; Walmart-as-tenant comps at \$27K–\$56K/ac/yr) [16][17][34][35], on ~20-year NNN ground leases with flat base rent and 5% bumps at 5-year options — and always subject to Walmart's recorded ECR covenants: sole-discretion site-plan/design approval, prohibited-use lists (no grocery, pharmacy, discount store, warehouse club), transfer rights, and easements in Walmart's favor [24].

Two structural facts should drive any go/no-go: **(1) Walmart's posture is steady-state disposition, not motivated selling** — the apparent FY2026 drop in owned-store share (87.7% → 80.9%) is purely a reporting reclassification of ~360 owned buildings on ground-leased land, not sale-leasebacks (disposal proceeds actually *fell* to \$106M; land holdings *grew* \$1.4B) [1][2], and Walmart is now buying whole shopping centers (\$118M across three in 2025) to act as landlord [44] [45]. **(2) The tenant gets the anchor's traffic but none of the anchor's covenant** — Walmart pads carry no co-tenancy protection, closures come with little warning (269 stores in 2016; all 51 health centers on 45–90 days' notice in 2024), and Walmart's deed restrictions run 25–75 years and are litigated aggressively [24][26][28][49][82]. The opportunity is real, national, and accessible through three named CBRE brokers and SRS — but it is a relationship-and-LOI market priced deal-by-deal, not a browsable marketplace.

Key Findings

- The official channel is Walmart Realty via walmartrealty.com — not realty.walmart.com, which no longer resolves.** The portal markets "outlots, carve outs, large land tracts, former retail stores, and shopping center spaces" for lease or sale nationwide with a map search and regularly updated listings [4][5]. Deals initiate on Walmart's own LOI template (`wmt-loi.DOC`, live on the site but unreadable by automated tools) [6].
- Two national brokerages are the practical front door.** CBRE runs a dedicated Walmart Disposition Center for "excess land sites, including outlots and large land tracts, and former retail stores" — contacts: Thomas Flynn (Akron, +1 330 670 4409), Jim Sakanich (Chicago, +1 312 297 7690), Yoni Zvi (Milwaukee, +1 414 274 1618) [7]. SRS maintains a national "Walmart U.S. Pad Site & Disposition Portfolio" with grid/list/map views and a "Download all" export [8].
- Verified live inventory floor: 30+ marketed Walmart-owned pad/outlot properties in 16+ states (July 2026), Midwest-heavy.** Search-index enumeration found 26 distinct CBRE "Walmart Outlot" listing pages in 13 states (NE 5, MN 5, IN 3, WI 2, MI 2, GA 2, plus IA/IL/KS/KY/PA/TN/VA), plus 9+ SRS listings (TX/FL-heavy) and regional-broker listings (IL, TN). This is a floor, not a census — the c.2023 anchor of 557 total listings (all property types) bounds the upper end [9]–[15].
- Pricing is almost never published.** Nearly every Walmart-owned listing reads "Contact Broker For Pricing." The exceptions and comps: Appomattox VA outlots asking \$350–375K *for sale* (~\$150–190K/acre) [11]; ground-lease asks of \$350K/yr (Kapolei HI, 0.74 ac) [16] and \$140K/yr (Charleston SC shadow pad, 1 ac) [17]; Walmart-as-tenant ground rents of ~\$55.5K/ac/yr (Ocala FL) [34] and ~\$27.3K/ac/yr (Hickory NC) [35]. There is no national rack rate — ground rent is set per-market off land value.
- The deal architecture is documented in SEC filings: Walmart keeps control after the deal.** The 2012 Walmart–Murphy Oil outlot agreement (the canonical public template) conveys pads as-is by special warranty deed subject to a recorded ECR: sole-and-absolute-discretion approval over site plans, building placement, parking, signage and any material change (30-day review loops), prohibited uses (grocery/supermarket, pharmacy, discount store, warehouse club, plus others), transfer restrictions with Walmart purchase rights (ROFR-style, per Murphy USA's 10-K), \$5M liability insurance naming Walmart, a holiday construction blackout (Oct 31–Jan 31), and Walmart sign/utility easements *on the pad* [24].
- Walmart is also a landlord inside the box: 13,000+ inline spaces, 4,500+ stores with leased space, 350+ brands** via the separate "Your Shop At Walmart" program (leasing.walmart.com) — pop-ups (Popable partnership) through multi-year leases, governed by the ISO Handbook and 4th Wall buildout guidelines, with a stated 2–4 week application review [53]–[59]. Don't confuse this channel with pad sites; both get called "leasing space at Walmart."
- Supply outlook is steady-state, not a sell-off.** The FY26 owned-share drop is a reclassification (~311 Walmart U.S. stores + ~50 Sam's Clubs are owned buildings on ground-leased land, now reported as leased) — zero sale-leasebacks, disposal proceeds down to \$106M, land up \$1.4B [1][2]. New-store creation is slow (9 new U.S. stores in 2025; ~20 scheduled for 2026 vs. 650+ remodels), so pad supply comes overwhelmingly from the existing ~4,600-store base [41] [42]. Meanwhile Walmart's own EV fast-charging build-out (73 locations/612 connectors by July 2026, targeting thousands of stores by 2030) competes internally for prime lot corners [48].
- Tenant demand is drive-thru QSR/coffee, banks, auto, medical — and the traffic case is quantified.** Recent named deals: Whataburger outparcel ground lease at a metro-Memphis Supercenter (14-yr, sold Oct 2024) [64]; Scooter's Coffee 10-yr NNN ground lease on an Avon Park FL pad (2024) [65]. Walmart's fleet drew +2.3% YoY visits in Q4 2025 with 34% of shoppers visiting 4+ times/month [68]. Inline, Charleys Cheesesteaks is converting hundreds of former Subway/McDonald's spaces; Jackson Hewitt runs 2,600+ kiosks [66][67].

9. **The risk stack is asymmetric: you pay anchor-adjacent pricing but hold no anchor covenant.** Pad tenants of a shadow anchor have no co-tenancy remedy if the store goes dark [39][40]; Walmart's 2016 closure of 269 stores and its 45–90-day shutdown of all 51 health centers in 2024 are the severity precedents [49][82]; deed restrictions (25–75 years) can kill a future concept pivot — though enforcement against successors is contestable (Walmart's covenant was *reversed* on appeal in *Bernard Court*, Ark. App. 2020) and Rhode Island banned new grocery deed restrictions effective July 1, 2026 [26][27][28].
10. **"Across the countries": Canada has no public pad portal (broker/relationship-driven; C\$6.5B expansion + Nov 2024 waiver of restrictive property controls changes the terms landscape) [86][87]; Mexico does — Walmex runs an official Bienes Raíces portal covering land sales, locale rental, and "Excess property" land rental across 3,316 Mexico units [89].**

1. How the Program Works: Walmart Realty

Walmart is structurally unusual among big-box retailers: it is its own landlord. Per the FY2026 10-K, Walmart U.S. owned 3,728 of 4,611 retail units (80.9%), Sam's Club owned 464 of 601, and Walmart typically owns the land under and around its stores — 698.7M sq ft of Walmart U.S. retail space alone [1]. When Walmart assembles a Supercenter site, it habitually buys more land than the store needs, then sells or leases the surplus pads while controlling co-tenancy — a practice documented as far back as a 2004 trade profile of Walmart Realty ("so we don't have bars or pawnshops") [72]. Excess acreage on Walmart-owned parcels became so common that Walmart formalized the channel: it hired CBRE and built an interactive disposition website to sell or lease excess land sites and former stores [75].

Walmart Realty (Bentonville) is the operating unit. Its public surface is **walmartrealty.com** — note that `realty.walmart.com`, the hostname that appears in older references, no longer resolves in DNS. The portal's own description: "Walmart Realty has multiple excess properties available for lease or sale across the country, including outlots, carve outs, large land tracts, former retail stores, and shopping center spaces," with a map search filterable by Building vs. Land, transaction type (Own/Lease/Ground lease), and size bands; listings are "updated regularly and are subject to change" [4][5]. The site hosts Walmart's standard Letter of Intent template (`wmt-Loi.DOC`) — deals start on Walmart's paper, not yours [6]. Circa March 2023 the portal showed **557 available listings** across all excess-property types — the only historical count on record, and an upper-bound anchor since it includes former stores and shopping-center space, not just pads [9].

Internally, this is an institutionalized, staffed function, not ad hoc: current Walmart job postings describe a Director-level asset-management role explicitly chartered with "shopping center sales, **outparcel dispositions**, and monetization of underperforming or non-strategic assets," a Tenant Leasing group, and regional portfolio managers each covering ~400 operating stores [61][62]. A 2004 profile of the program (dated, but structural) described 380 buildings and ~350 land parcels offered simultaneously, 240 outparcels sold in a single year, ~70% of dispositions broker-listed, and a weekly Deal Committee of Walmart Realty VPs approving transactions — with ground leases also done for billboards, ATMs, and solar [72]. Walmart has also historically cleared low-value pads at absolute auction (26 TX/LA outlots via Higgenbotham in 2010; a Norton, VA outparcel ran through a \$1-reserve auction as recently as July 2025) [73][14].

One important distinction runs through everything: **Walmart-owned outlots vs. developer-owned "shadow-anchored" pads**. Most listings that surface when you search "Walmart outparcel for lease" are pads at Walmart-anchored or Walmart-adjacent centers owned by third parties (developers, strip-center owners, net-lease investors) — you'd lease from them, not Walmart, though Walmart's recorded REA/ECR restrictions usually still govern the dirt [24][80]. The Walmart-owned inventory routes through walmartrealty.com, CBRE, and SRS.

2. What's Actually Listed Right Now (July 2026)

The census problem. All three official surfaces block automated access: walmartrealty.com sits behind Akamai bot protection (HTTP 403 to every fetcher tried; compressed garbage to crawlers), SRS's portfolio page loads listings client-side ("Showing Properties: 0 of 0" in static HTML — though its "Download all" export is confirmed present), and CBRE's Disposition Center portfolio page is an iframe map. Even archive.org was unreachable from this environment. So no authoritative current total exists in the public record; what follows is a rigorously verified **floor** built from search-index enumeration, with individual listings fetched live wherever possible.

CBRE channel — 26 distinct live "Walmart Outlot/Outparcel" listing pages found on cbre.com, spanning 13 states, 69% Midwest/Plains [10]–[14]:

STATE	COUNT	EXAMPLE LISTINGS (VERIFIED LIVE)
Nebraska	5	La Vista 1.64 ac (sale/lease, C-1: "retail, restaurant, drive-thru"); Lincoln 2.58 ac; Blair; Columbus; Bellevue
Minnesota	5	Fairmont, Park Rapids 2.16 ac, Dilworth, New Ulm, Inver Grove Heights (several sale-only, 0.99–1.47 ac)
Indiana	3	Evansville 1.33 ac; Plainfield; Avon
Wisconsin / Michigan / Georgia	2 each	Janesville, Sheboygan; Fowlerville, Escanaba; Warner Robins 0.96 ac, Blairsville

STATE	COUNT	EXAMPLE LISTINGS (VERIFIED LIVE)
IA · IL · KS · KY · PA · TN · VA	1 each	Anamosa IA pads 0.75–1.02 ac; Elgin IL two outparcels 8.84 + 3.78 ac (12.59 ac total), available immediately, sale or direct lease ; Wichita KS; Middletown KY; Brownsville PA 1.95 + 2.05 ac; La Vergne TN; Appomattox VA — the pricing-transparency exception: Outlot 1, 2.40 ac at \$375K; Outlot 2, 1.84 ac at \$350K (sale)

The Midwest skew is corroborated three ways: CBRE's own portfolio copy ("Multiple locations are available throughout the Midwest, and United States"), all three named CBRE contacts sitting in Akron/Chicago/Milwaukee, and the listing sample itself [7]. It is dominant, not exclusive — GA/TN/VA/KY listings exist.

SRS channel — 9+ indexed listings, TX/FL-heavy, including genuine ground-lease product at new stores [8][15]: Lady Lake FL (The Villages trade area) — five pads of 0.81–2.44 ac explicitly "For Ground Lease" at a new Walmart Neighborhood Market, of which only two premium pads remained at the March 2026 syndication update (evidence pads sell through); Avon Park FL; Lufkin, Wichita Falls, Plano, Fort Worth (7.17-ac "Walmart Excess Property"), San Antonio TX; Medford OR; Auburn AL (sale or lease).

Regional brokers and marketplaces: Walmart outlots also surface through local brokers (Pace Properties — Carlyle IL; Retail Specialists — Tullahoma TN ~2 ac ground lease; Coldwell Banker Commercial — Danville IL at \$5.00/SF) and syndicate to LoopNet/Crexii/CommercialSearch — where they mix with the much larger population of third-party shadow-anchored pads (active 2024–26 examples in NE, SC, TN, IL, HI, TX, MS, MD, PA, DE) [18]–[23]. Time-on-market signal: the Kapolei HI pad has been marketed since March 2024 — 2+ years — a caution on absorption in remote markets [16].

Bottom line on inventory: ≥30 officially marketed Walmart-owned pad/outlot properties in 16+ states right now, with the true marketed portfolio bounded between that floor and the stale 557 all-types figure. Deal-type mix on observable listings: mostly "For Sale/Lease" flexible, a minority sale-only, lease type "Direct," pricing on request. **A 10-minute human browser session on walmartrealty.com + the SRS "Download all" export + the CBRE portfolio map would close this gap completely** — no automated tool available to this research could.

3. The Third-Party Channels

Four distinct populations of "Walmart pads" exist outside Walmart's own portal, and they behave differently:

- Walmart's listing brokers (official inventory).** CBRE (Disposition Center; Midwest-led team) and SRS (national pad-site portfolio). SRS separately describes the model: "Retail big boxes with large sites can carve out land from their parking lot to create a pad site which can be ground leased or sold to a complementary user" — and an SRS-bylined piece describes disposing stores/pads for an unnamed national discount retailer across 34 states: 150+ transactions, \$400M+ recovered [7][8][74].
- Shadow-center consolidators (lease from them, not Walmart).** MRP Capital Group (St. Louis) is the self-described largest owner-operator of "Walmart Shadow Centers" in small-town America — 100+ properties, 2.6M SF, 26 states, ~\$350M portfolio (self-reported, 2022) [76]. Others active 2025–26: Core Equity Partners (bought a multi-center Walmart shadow portfolio June 2025), RCG Ventures, Broad Reach Retail Partners [77]. Institutional ownership of this asset class dates back at least to a 2016 CMBS pool of 34 Walmart-shadow properties across 14 states [80].
- Net-lease investment brokers (completed pads as investments).** Marcus & Millichap, Boulder Group, SRS>NNLG trade finished outparcels: a \$5.2M Capital One + IHOP outparcel sale at a Baton Rouge Walmart shadow center (May 2025, part of a \$12M break-up), raw pads on Crexi ~\$425K, completed net-leased outparcels at 5.45–7.00% caps [78][79]. Parcelization/break-up of Walmart-anchored centers is a recurring 2025 strategy.
- Marketplaces (mixed population).** LoopNet/Crexii/CommercialSearch carry dozens of "Walmart outparcel" listings — always check who the landlord actually is.

A critical deal-terms reality documented in FrontView REIT's SEC filings: **Walmart's approval rights and use/size restrictions encumber pads even when third parties own them** — FrontView had to negotiate Walmart's consent (via a lease extension) just to carve a new 1-acre pad on a Walmart-leased site, and discovered an undisclosed Walmart-enforceable size restriction on a Buffalo Wild Wings outparcel it bought, which it had to get amended during due diligence [38]. The third-party channels are lead-generation surfaces; the restrictions are Walmart's either way.

4. Deal Structures, Terms & Economics

Three documented structures:

- Fee sale subject to a recorded ECR** ("Easements with Covenants and Restrictions Affecting Land"). The canonical public template is the SEC-filed 2012 Walmart–Murphy Oil Agreement of Sale covering a national outlot/carveout portfolio [24]: special warranty deed, AS-IS/WHERE-IS; ECR recorded immediately after each deed; Walmart plats/replats in "sole and absolute discretion"; buyer reimburses survey/plat costs above thresholds.
- Ground lease of the pad** — from Walmart Realty directly (via CBRE/SRS/local listing brokers) or from a third-party owner whose land sits under Walmart's REA/ECR. Observed lease type on CBRE listings: "Direct."
- Walmart as ground tenant on your land** — a different product entirely (investor owns land under a Walmart store), included here only because its pricing calibrates the market.

What Walmart keeps (from the 2012 ECR/agreement — 14 years old, structural evidence, current forms may differ) [24]: - **Sole-and-absolute-discretion approval** of the buyer's entire development plan — site plan, setbacks, parking configuration and dimensions, driveways, building placement/size, architectural design, color scheme, landscaping, elevations, signage — *before* the buyer may even submit to a government authority, with a mandatory 30-day revise-and-resubmit loop that repeats until Walmart approves, and the same rights again on any material modification. - **Use restrictions:** sole-permitted-use clauses plus prohibited-use lists — no discount store, wholesale/membership warehouse club, grocery store/supermarket, pharmacy/drug store; no theater, bowling alley, health spa/fitness; adult uses banned; Murphy's convenience kiosk capped at 1,200 SF. Restrictions can blanket whole developments: a ~20-year-old Walmart covenant at Centre Pointe (North Charleston, SC) bars any gas station, grocery, drug store, or 35,000+ SF department store across several hundred acres, a mile beyond the store [25]. - **Transfer control:** ECR purchase rights that operate as a right of first refusal / first offer on proposed transfers plus a ban on transfers to Walmart competitors (per Murphy USA's own 10-K disclosure — commonly mislabeled a "buyback option"). - **Operational encumbrances:** Walmart easements *on the pad* for its pylon/monument signs and lot lighting; \$5M liability insurance naming Walmart (self-insurance only at \$200M+ net worth); holiday construction blackout Oct 31–Jan 31; shared truck-easement maintenance (25% pad / 75% Walmart).

Ground rent — the honest answer is "it's a per-market negotiation," and here is the full public comp set:

COMP	TYPE	RENT	PER ACRE/YR
Kapolei, HI — 0.74 ac Walmart-fronting pad (Colliers, active)	Ground-lease ask	\$350,000/yr	~\$475K (Hawaii premium) [16]
Charleston, SC — 1.0 ac shadow pad, shares curb cut with Chick-fil-A	Ground-lease ask	\$140,000/yr	~\$140K [17]
Somerset, PA — 1.2 ac Lowe's-anchored pad (comparable benchmark)	Ground-lease ask	\$70,000/yr	~\$58K [36]
Ocala, FL — Walmart NM on 5.95 ac (Walmart as tenant)	Executed GL	\$330,000/yr	~\$55.5K [34]
Hickory, NC — Walmart NM on 6.4 ac (Walmart as tenant)	Executed GL	\$175,000/yr	~\$27.3K [35]
Appomattox, VA — Walmart outlots (sale, the rare posted price)	Fee ask	\$350–375K	~\$150–190K/ac sale [11]
Temple, TX — 1.86 ac Walmart outlot	Fee ask	\$1.62M	~\$871K/ac sale [18]

At the CRE convention of ~6–9% ground-rent yield on land value, the sale asks imply ground rents bracketing the observed comps. **No evidence in asking data that Walmart pads command a systematic per-acre premium over other big-box-anchored pads** — brand credit and market land value drive pricing.

Structure norms (converging across the Ocala OM, Hickory listing, Boulder Group data, and Net Lease Advisor): ~20-year initial terms (15-yr typical on new construction per Boulder), absolute NNN, flat base rent, **5% escalations per 5-year option** (occasionally 10% on the first option), and very long option tails — up to 14 five-year options [30][33][34][35].

Cap-rate context (for underwriting a build on a pad): Boulder Group Q2 2026 — overall single-tenant net lease 6.82%, retail 6.60%; tightest ground leases (McDonald's, Chick-fil-A) asking ~4.45% [31]. Walmart-credit assets: Q1 2026 tenant profile (S&P AA, typical lease type: ground lease) asks 5.55–5.85% at 15-yr term, 6.00–6.30% at 10-yr, 6.45–6.75% at 5-yr; a Germantown WI Supercenter closed May 2026 at 6.05% with 6 years left [30][31]. Walmart pricing has widened ~100+ bps since the ZIRP era (5.15% in Feb 2020) [33].

What we still can't see: the contents of Walmart's LOI template (deposit, DD period, closing timeline — the file is live and opens in any browser/Word; a 30-second manual download closes this), and any executed Walmart-as-landlord pad ground lease with a full rent schedule. Every active Walmart-owned ground-lease listing found (Kapolei, Grand Island NE, Waukesha WI, Tullahoma TN, Carlyle IL, San Antonio TX) is quote-on-request [6][16][19]–[22].

5. Walmart's 2024–26 Real-Estate Strategy — What It Means for Pad Supply

Growth is remodel-led, so pads come from the existing base. January 2024: commit to build/convert 150+ stores over five years and remodel 650/year across 47 states + Puerto Rico ("Store of the Future") [41]. Reality: 9 new U.S. stores opened in 2025; ~20 grand openings scheduled 2026/early-2027 vs. 650+ remodels (which include "improved parking and landscaping" — i.e., lot reconfiguration) [42]. Capex is at historic highs (\$23.8B FY25, guided 3–3.5% of sales) but aimed at remodels, new builds, and supply-chain automation; **no earnings-call discussion of outparcel or rent income exists — pad monetization runs quietly through Walmart Realty** [43].

The ownership-share "drop" is an accounting artifact — and a diligence insight. Walmart U.S. owned share fell 87.7% (FY25) → 80.9% (FY26) not from sale-leasebacks but from a new 10-K classification rule: "Owned retail units on leased land are reflected as leased locations." ~311 Walmart U.S. stores + ~50 Sam's Clubs moved columns while the fleet grew by 6 units; "sale-leaseback" appears zero times in the FY26 10-K; property-disposal proceeds *fell* to \$106M (from \$432M); land *rose* \$1.4B to \$20.75B; U.S. long-lived assets grew \$13.1B [1][2]. Two implications: (a) supply-side — Walmart is not a motivated seller; expect ordinary-course dispositions, not a liquidation window; (b) deal-side — **~7–8% of U.S. stores sit on ground-leased land where Walmart cannot convey fee title to a pad** (sublease/assignment structures at best); confirm land tenure early in any site-specific pursuit.

Walmart is becoming a landlord, which cuts both ways. In calendar 2025 it spent \$118.1M buying three shopping centers — Monroeville Mall PA (\$34M, to be demolished for a ~780K SF Walmart-anchored mixed-use district with Cypress Equities, ~2029), Bethel Park PA (\$39.6M), Walmart Center Norwalk CT (\$44.5M, with Ulta/Panera/Aspen Dental as rent-paying co-tenants) [44]–[47]. Walmart calls these "one-off projects," but analysts read a Publix-style control-the-real-estate

posture. For pad seekers: fewer fee sales at strategic sites, but potentially *more* leasable Walmart-controlled space over time. The 2018–19 “town center” parking-lot-conversion concept largely stalled — treat broker pitches citing it as history [51][52].

Internal claimants on the parking lot. Walmart’s own 400kW EV fast-charging network (launched April 2025; ~73 locations/612 connectors by July 2026; target: thousands of stores by 2030) is Walmart’s highest-priority use for prime lot corners — direct competition for the same real estate a third-party ground tenant wants [48]. Walmart Health’s April 2024 shutdown (all 51 centers, 45–90 days’ notice) redirected remodels toward Vision Centers/pharmacies and made third-party medical/dental the courted tenant archetype rather than a Walmart-operated one [49][50].

6. The Leasing Process — Practical Playbook

For pad sites / outparcels (land): 1. **Start with the brokers of record, not Walmart:** CBRE Walmart Disposition Center (Flynn/Sakanich/Zvi, contacts above) and the SRS Walmart portfolio page; add LoopNet/Crexio/CommercialSearch alerts for “Walmart outlet”/“Walmart outparcel” to catch regional-broker and third-party listings [7][8]. 2. **Verify who owns the dirt** (Walmart Realty vs. shadow-center owner vs. small investor) and **pull the recorded ECR/REA before falling in love** — restrictions run with the land regardless of owner [24][38][81]. 3. **Submit an LOI on Walmart’s template** (wmt-loi.DOC from walmartrealty.com). Expect Walmart’s paper, Walmart’s process [6]. 4. **Underwrite the approval gauntlet:** 30-day Walmart review loops on site plan and design (sole discretion), then normal municipal entitlement on top; budget the holiday construction blackout if your work touches Walmart’s tract [24]. 5. **Inquiries at stores with no active listing** route to Walmart Realty’s regional portfolio managers (each covers ~400 stores) via the brokers [62].

For inline space (inside the store) — a different program entirely: search spaces by store at leasing.walmart.com (“Your Shop At Walmart”), apply against a specific store # and space # (business description, type, location count, annual sales); stated review 2–4 weeks (per a third-party scrape of Walmart’s FAQ — verify on the live page); operate as an “Independent Service Operator” under the ISO Handbook (minimum hours: open by 10 a.m. Mon–Sat, 1 p.m. Sun; liquidated-damages exposure) and 4th Wall buildout guidelines (Walmart approves all plans/signage; ~600–2,200 SF spaces; non-competing uses) [53]–[59]. Pop-ups run through the Popable partnership (1 month–1 year, negotiated with Walmart) [56][57]; some emerging-brand access flows through master-lease intermediaries (Twin Towers Trading holds a Master Lease Agreement with Walmart; sister company Concept Development Solutions manages placements — vendor-claimed 2,500+ locations, unaudited) [63].

7. Who Leases Walmart Pads — and Why

Outparcel tenant archetypes: drive-thru QSR and coffee (the dominant category — Chick-fil-A, Raising Cane’s, Dutch Bros, Scooter’s, Whataburger), banks/credit unions, car wash, auto service, dental/medical, cellular. Named recent deals: **Whataburger** on a Walmart Supercenter outparcel in metro Memphis — 3,318 SF, 14-year corporate ground lease, sold Oct 2024 to a 1031 buyer; **Scooter’s Coffee** — new-construction pad at Avon Park FL Walmart, 10-yr NNN ground lease commencing 2024 [64][65]. Note on auto: Walmart operates its own Auto Care Centers in 2,582 Supercenters — validation of demand, but also in-house competition for auto-service concepts [85].

The traffic case: 90% of Americans live within 10 miles of a Walmart; 38.5M people shop daily [53]. Placer.ai: Q4 2025 visits +2.3% YoY after a second-half surge; 34.0% of shoppers visit 4+ times/month (May–Jul 2025); the single busiest store (Sevierville, TN) drew 571.6K visits in June 2025 alone. Visits are essentials-driven and consistent across weekdays — exactly the pattern drive-thru and service tenants want [68][69]. Honest caveat: **no rigorous quantified sales-lift study for Walmart-shadow tenants exists publicly** — the performance case rests on traffic data and broker assertion.

Inline tenant economy (context for the pad thesis): Regal Nails ~1,000 salons; DaVi Nails 500+; Jackson Hewitt 2,600+ tax kiosks; Charleys Cheesesteaks converting hundreds of former Subway/McDonald’s spaces through 2025; robot-run ghost kitchens (Richtech/Ghost Kitchens America, 20 more Walmart restaurants announced Oct 2024 — a high-churn category) [66][67][70]. The 2021 McDonald’s exodus (peak ~1,000 in-store units → ~150) is what opened today’s inline backfill wave.

8. Geography — U.S. Concentration and the International Picture

The availability base: 4,611 Walmart U.S. stores + 601 Sam’s Clubs = 5,212 U.S. units (Jan 31, 2026; FY27 Q1 update: 4,614 / 5,215), in all 50 states, DC, and Puerto Rico [1][3]. Largest state footprints: Texas ~510, Florida ~345, California ~272 [71].

Where marketed Walmart-owned pads cluster: the Midwest/Plains, per CBRE’s own language, its Midwest broker bench, and the 69% listing skew — consistent with the long tail of excess outlots left behind by decades of small-market Supercenter conversions, and with the historical pattern (the 2010 auction was entirely small-market TX/LA) [7][10]–[14][73]. Sun-belt “Walmart outlet” listings exist (GA, TN, VA, TX, FL via SRS) but skew third-party/shadow-anchored. **Growth-market pads at new stores do appear and move fast** — Lady Lake FL’s five ground-lease pads were down to two premium pads within months [15].

Canada (404 stores): no public Walmart-Realty-style portal — the old walmart.ca “Lease Space” page is dead; excess-land monetization runs through Walmart Canada’s Mississauga real-estate team and external brokers (SRS’s portfolio filter notably includes Ontario) [8]. Two live dynamics: the **C\$6.5B five-year investment announced Jan 30, 2025** (“dozens of new stores,” first five Supercentres in ON/AB by 2027, incl. Taza Park, Tsuut’ina Nation) will create new pad supply at greenfield sites [86][88]; and on **Nov 22, 2024 Walmart Canada unilaterally waived all competitive property controls** in its leases and land agreements amid Competition Bureau scrutiny — dismantling the restrictive-covenant regime that governs Canadian co-tenancy [87].

Mexico & Central America: Walmex runs an official portal — bienesraices.walmartmexico.com.mx — covering land offers (*terrenos*), rental of commercial locales, and rental of excess land explicitly labeled "Excess property," across 3,316 Mexico units + 949 Central America units [89]. It's a landing page (listing depth unverified) but it is the official front door.

Everything else: after divesting the UK (Asda), Japan (Seiyu), and Argentina in 2020–21, Walmart's ownership footprint for any pad thesis is US/Canada/Mexico/Central America/Chile (403 Lider units; no public pad program found) plus China/India/Africa positions [90][3].

9. Risks & Pitfalls

- 1. No co-tenancy remedy — ever — on the anchor you're paying for.** Walmart is a shadow anchor: it owns its own store and is not named in your pad lease, so if it goes dark you have no rent relief or termination right (CMBS risk-factor boilerplate flags exactly this; where Walmart co-tenancy protection exists it's in third-party landlord-owned inline space, not pads bought or leased from Walmart) [39][40]. Underwrite the store's traffic as a bonus you can lose, not a draw you control.
- 2. Dark-store tail risk: low frequency, high severity, little warning.** Current closures are a trickle (~10–12 US stores/yr, 2024–26; Walmart has publicly disputed viral mass-closure lists) [85]. But the precedents are stark: January 2016 — 269 stores closed at once (154 US, all 102 Express), stranding small-town co-located businesses [82][83]; relocations strand neighbors just as effectively (Seabrook NH) [84]; and Walmart killed its entire 51-clinic health format on 45–90 days' notice in April 2024 [49]. Closures are portfolio optimization, not distress — they arrive healthy.
- 3. Deed-restriction traps run for decades.** Walmart conveys outparcels and exits stores with 25–75-year restrictive covenants (no grocery, pharmacy, discount, etc.). A 1997 Jonesboro AR deed barred discount/grocery use for **50 years** and surfaced only when a successor tried to lease to Dirt Cheap in 2019 — though note the Arkansas Court of Appeals ultimately **reversed** enforcement against the successor (*Bernard Court*, 2020 Ark. App. 563): Walmart drafts restrictions to bind successors and litigates them, but enforcement is contestable [28]. The Woonsocket RI exit restriction (25 years; store vacant six years; contributed to a ~45,000-person food desert) drew FTC attention under Lina Khan and produced Rhode Island's first-in-nation ban on grocery deed restrictions — signed July 1, 2026, prospective-only [26][27]. Walmart also litigates asymmetrically — enforcing its own covenants while fighting competitors' covenants to the federal appeals level (*Dan's Super Market v. Wal-Mart*, 8th Cir.) [29]. **Diligence rule: pull the full chain of title and every recorded ECR/REA before contract.**
- 4. The REA ambush.** Developers routinely discover months into a project that the recorded REA controls use, signage, parking, hours, and cost-sharing on their parcel, with Walmart holding approval rights over changes (Holland & Knight, March 2026; ICSC; ABA) [81]. FrontView REIT's SEC-disclosed Buffalo Wild Wings surprise is the cautionary case study [38].
- 5. Financing friction on unsubordinated ground leases.** Walmart (or a center owner) will not subordinate its fee; lenders often require subordination, so expect leasehold-mortgage structures, more equity, and improvements reverting on default [37][38].
- 6. Pricing risk.** Pad ground leases at big-box-anchored sites price at premium (low) cap rates (QSR pad stack ~4.4–6.8% vs. 6.82% market average) driven by tenant credit — but on a Walmart pad you're paying anchor-adjacent land pricing for traffic you cannot contractually keep (see #1). If the store goes dark, the premium evaporates with no remedy [30][31][32].
- 7. Concept-fit gate.** Walmart's prohibited-use lists (grocery, pharmacy, fuel, discount) and its own expanding footprint (Auto Care, EV charging, financial services) pre-empt whole categories — check the ECR *and* Walmart's own roadmap before pursuing a site [24][48][85].

Implications & Recommendations

- If the goal is securing a pad (own use or client):** go straight to the named humans — CBRE's Flynn/Sakanich/Zvi and SRS's Walmart portfolio team — with a concept Walmart's ECRs permit (drive-thru QSR/coffee, bank, medical/dental, cellular, car wash). Expect LOI on Walmart's template, "contact for pricing," a 30-day sole-discretion design gauntlet, and a 20-year NNN ground lease with 5%-per-option bumps. Budget legal for ECR/REA review as a first-dollar cost, not a closing formality.
- Three 10-minute manual actions would make this decision-grade:** (1) browse walmartrealty.com and record the live listing count/geography; (2) hit "Download all" on the SRS portfolio page; (3) download and read `wmt - loi .DOC` (deposit/DD/closing terms). All three are blocked to automation but trivial in a normal browser.
- If the angle is investment:** the interesting asymmetry is small-market Midwest outlots (thin demand, negotiable pricing, sale-or-lease flexibility) vs. growth-market pads at new stores (Lady Lake-style, sell through in months). Shadow-center break-up plays (buy center, parcelize pads) are an active 2025 institutional strategy worth studying via MRP/Core Equity precedents.
- If the angle is consulting IP:** this channel map (Walmart Realty → CBRE/SRS → LOI → ECR gauntlet) generalizes to every big-box owner-operator (Target, Home Depot, Lowe's, Costco run analogous excess-property programs). A "big-box pad-site access playbook" is a productizable deliverable, and the Walmart GC-insourcing whitepaper already in the Research program is a natural companion piece.
- Watch items:** Walmart's landlord pivot (more center purchases would shift supply from fee sales to Walmart-controlled leasing); EV charging consuming lot corners; the FY27 10-K for whether the ground-lease reclassification stays stable; Rhode Island-style deed-restriction legislation spreading.

Knowledge Gaps

- **No authoritative current inventory census** — walmartrealty.com, the SRS export, and the CBRE map all require a human browser session; the ~30-listing floor vs. 557 (all types, March 2023) bounds are the best public evidence.
- **Walmart's opening deal terms unread** — wmt-loi.DOC is live but unparseable by every automated channel tried; deposit, DD period, and closing timeline unknown.
- **No executed Walmart-as-landlord pad ground lease** with full rent schedule is public; the per-acre comp set (2 asks + 2 Walmart-as-tenant comps + 1 Lowe's benchmark) spans ~2x and cannot establish whether Walmart pads price at a premium to comparable shadow pads.
- **Current ECR form** — the 2012 Murphy template is the newest public example; current restriction durations/terms on pad ECRs are undocumented.
- **Popable partnership status post-2022** and inline rent/insurance/credit thresholds are not public.
- **No quantified post-closure damage study** for pad tenants at dark Walmart sites (mechanism documented; magnitude not).
- **CBRE vs. SRS mandate split** (region? product? vintage?) is unannounced; neither appointment has a press release.

Methodology

Nine parallel research tracks (program mechanics, live inventory, third-party channels, deal terms, corporate strategy, process, tenants, geography/international, risks), each executed by an independent research agent running 4–6 web searches plus full-content fetches, then **adversarially verified** by a second agent that attempted to refute each track's load-bearing claims against primary sources (verdicts: 31 CONFIRMED/PARTIAL across 36 checks; all corrections absorbed into this text — e.g., the Placer.ai date fix, the *Bernard Court* reversal, the ROFR-not-buyback correction, and the FY26 reclassification finding). A completeness critic then identified three decision-grade gaps (inventory census, ground-lease economics, ownership-share anomaly), each closed as far as public data allows by dedicated gap-fill agents. Fetch limitations: walmartrealty.com, srsre.com, mapping.cbre.com, sec.gov, and archive.org block automated fetchers from this environment; verification used the Exa renderer, Walmart IR documents, and independent corroboration. 22 agents, 507 tool calls, 257 sources collected, ~180 unique.

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90	Walmart FY2021 Form 10-Q — Asda/Seiyu/Argentina divestitures (SEC)	https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/104169/000010416921000058/wmt-20210731.htm	2021